

iQOO Z10 Lite 5G

It delivers where needed most

Lately, I have been reviewing phones that usually fall somewhere between ₹20,000 and ₹40,000. This is the sweet spot where brands are making solid progress day by day. But every time I looked below ₹10,000, it felt like this segment still hasn't had its moment to shine, no? You have either had to compromise on performance, quality of display, or some basic features that should have been a given by now. So when the iQOO Z10 Lite 5G landed on my desk, priced at ₹9,999, I didn't expect much. Now, after testing it, I know that it wants to shake things up in this budget space, but can it? Let's find out.

DESIGN

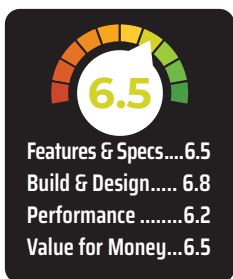
I have been using the Titanium Blue variant, which looks quite classy, but the back panel catches smudges and fingerprints easily.

Especially since it's a lighter shade, those marks are hard to miss.

Still, the form factor works. It is not too wide, sits nicely in the pocket, and even though it feels a little bulky, it never feels too uncomfortable to use, unless you are trying to scroll through Instagram one-handedly. So if you are worried about accidental drops, definitely hold it with both hands.

Speaking of drops, it is impressive that at ₹9,999, this phone offers IP64 water/dust resistance and even military-grade durability. The plastic build helps here too, less chance of cracking if it takes a fall. It's a solid design choice for the budget-conscious buyer.

₹9,999



DISPLAY

The iQOO Z10 Lite 5G comes with a 6.74-inch HD+ IPS LCD panel, and while it's not the most pixel-packed screen out there, it does its job without trying too hard. The colours are surprisingly natural, which I actually prefer. No oversaturation, no weird warm tones. Just clean, decent visuals.

We clocked the peak brightness at 836 nits on Auto Mode. Indoors or in shade, you're good. Outdoors in direct sunlight, though? It becomes a mirror. The reflections take over, and you'll find yourself squinting or cranking up the brightness manually.

But here's where I felt a little let down: it only supports 90Hz refresh rate. And while it feels smooth enough in daily use, you notice the difference when you are gaming or switching

back and forth between apps. Once you have experienced 120Hz, going back is like switching from an expressway to a bumpy flyover. It's not a dealbreaker, but yeah, 120Hz should be the new normal.



PERFORMANCE

The iQOO Z10 Lite 5G is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 6300 and comes with up to 8GB RAM and 256GB storage. In our benchmark testing, it scored over 4.3 lakh points on AnTuTu, which is a rather impressive number if we take a look at its price tag. Geekbench scores were also on par with what you would expect at this price point.

Even during our 15-minute stress test, the performance remained fairly stable. There were neither wild drops nor weird heating issues. Budget phones usually don't throttle heavily, and this one held up pretty well too.

Real-world use was solid, too. I used this as my secondary phone for a few days, switching between WhatsApp, Instagram, BGMI (on basic settings), snapping photos, streaming videos, and it held up fine. Sure, a few stutters popped up when I had too many apps open, but nothing deal-breaking.

At this price, I was honestly expecting it to crawl under pressure. But it didn't and kept up pace.

CAMERA

The iQOO Z10 Lite 5G is equipped with a dual camera setup, consisting of a 50-megapixel main camera and a 2-megapixel depth sensor.

If we talk about pictures, it delivers a decent camera performance for a phone at this price point. In well-lit conditions, the primary camera captures sharp and balanced shots with natural colours. Whether it's buildings, greenery, or objects like bikes and logos, the images show respectable detail with minimal noise. However, the dynamic range could have been better.

